

U.S. HISTORY HACK™ · SCAFFOLD SUPPORTS

Scaffold & Language-Access Companion

Use alongside the US.01 Homestead Act Document-Based Investigation

Everything you need to do your first DBQ with confidence.

Works ALONGSIDE — never in place of — a student's IEP / 504 accommodations.

Worked HIPPO + OPTIC models · EN/ES word bank · sentence stems · bucketing organizer · thesis builder · step-by-step checklist · TroopToTeacher Technologies LLC
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1 · Your DBQ Checklist — do these in order

- 1 **READ** the document and its context note. Use the Plain-Language box for the two law excerpts.
- 2 **SOURCE IT.** Fill the HIPPO box (text) or OPTIC box (picture). Ask: who made it, when, and why?
- 3 **SORT.** Which lens does it fit — gained a homestead, lost a homeland, or who decided?
- 4 **PLAN.** Put your best documents in the bucketing organizer (section 5).
- 5 **WRITE.** Use the thesis builder (section 6) and the sentence stems (section 4), then check the rubric in your workbook.

2 · Worked HIPPO model (for text sources — Documents A & B)

Every text source: source it before you use it. Here is a completed model on Document A (the law).

MODEL — HIPPO on Document A

H — Historical context	"This law was passed in 1862, during the Civil War, when the government wanted people to settle the West."
I — Intended audience	"It speaks to ordinary people who wanted land — including immigrants becoming citizens."
P — Point of view	"It is written by the U.S. government, which wanted the West settled — so it treats the land as free to give away."
P — Purpose	"To get citizens to move west, farm the land, and build the nation."
O — Outside evidence	"I know this land was already home to Native nations, which the law ignores."

3 · Worked OPTIC model (for pictures & maps — Documents C-F)

Each picture is **its own document**. OPTIC = **O**verview · **P**arts · **T**itle/Text · **I**nterrelationships · **C**onclusion. Name what you see first, then say what it means.

MODEL — OPTIC on Document F (Tom Torlino)

O — Overview	"Two photos of the same young man — before and after a boarding school."
P — Parts	"Left: long hair, traditional clothing. Right: short hair, a suit and tie."
T — Title / Text	"The pairing is labeled 'before and after' — it wants us to see a change."
I — Interrelationships	"The school changed his hair, clothes, and name on purpose."

C — Conclusion

“This shows a real cost of settling the West: Native children were forced to give up their culture.”

4 • Sentence stems & frames

Sourcing: “Because Document ___ was made by ___ for ___, its purpose is ___, which means ___.”

Using a document: “Document ___ shows ___. This is evidence that ___ because ___.”

Weighing gain vs. cost: “While ___ gained ___ (Doc ___), ___ lost ___ (Doc ___).”

Thesis: “The Homestead Act gave ___ to ___, but it cost ___ for ___; therefore ___.”

Tennessee Connection: “In Tennessee, ___ (settlers heading west / the Cherokee removal) shows that ___.”

5 • Word bank (English / Español)

Term	Plain-language meaning	Español
homestead	a home and piece of land where a family lives and works	granja familiar
public land	land owned by the government	tierra pública
claim	a formal request to own or use land	reclamo / solicitud
affidavit	a written promise a person swears is true	declaración jurada
citizen	a legal member of a country	ciudadano/a
naturalization	the legal process of becoming a citizen	naturalización
cultivate	to prepare and grow crops on land	cultivar
patent	the official paper that proves you own the land	título de propiedad
revert	to go back to an earlier owner	revertir / volver
allegiance	loyalty to a country or government	lealtad
reservation	land set aside by the government for a Native nation	reserva
dispossession	the forced loss of land or property	despojo
transcontinental	crossing the whole continent	transcontinental

unappropriated	not yet claimed by the government for a use (but often Native homeland)	no asignado
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6 • Evidence-bucketing organizer

Write each document letter under the lens it supports. A document can appear under more than one.

Who gained a homestead? (docs)	Who lost a homeland? (docs)	Who decided? (docs)

7 • Thesis builder

Formula: a gain (“gave ___ to ___”) + a cost (“but cost ___ for ___”) + your judgment (“therefore ___”).

WRITE YOUR THESIS HERE

These supports add to — they never replace — a student's legally required IEP or 504 accommodations. Scaffold fading: use the full frames on Documents A-B, drop to reduced cues on C-E, and try Document F on your own.